

A **student** is a person enrolled in a [school](#) or other [educational institution](#), or more generally, a person who takes a special interest in a subject.^[1]

In the [United Kingdom](#) and most [commonwealth countries](#), a "student" attends a secondary school or higher (e.g., [college](#) or [university](#)); those in primary or elementary schools are "pupils".^[2]

Africa

Nigeria

In [Nigeria](#), [education](#) is classified into four systems known as a 6-3-3-4 system of education. It implies six years in primary school, three years in junior secondary, three years in senior secondary and four years in the university. However, the number of years to be spent in university is mostly determined by the course of study. Some courses have longer study lengths than others. Those in primary school are often referred to as pupils. Those in [university](#), as well as those in secondary school, are referred to as students.^[3]

The Nigerian system of education also has other recognized categories like the polytechnics and [colleges](#) of education. Colleges are more for teaching students how to become teachers, while polytechnics teach students about [engineering](#), [industrialization](#) and [economics](#).^[4]

South Africa



A group of high school girls of South Africa getting photographed

In [South Africa](#), [education](#) is divided into four grade groups: the Foundation Phase (grades 0–3), the Intermediate Phase (grades 4–6), the Senior Phase (grades 7–9), and the [Further Education](#) and Training or FET Phase (grades 10–12).^[5]

Asia



Taiwanese schoolgirls during [Japanese rule](#),

1927

Singapore

Six years of primary school education in [Singapore](#) are compulsory.^[6]

- Primary School (Primary 1 to 6)

Primary 1 to 3 (aged 7–9 respectively, Lower primary) Primary 4 to 6 (aged 10–12 respectively, Upper primary)

- Secondary School (Secondary 1 to 4 or 5)

Sec 1s are 13, and Sec 4s are 16. Express Students take secondary school from Sec 1 to 4, and Normal Acad and Technical will take secondary school from Sec 1 to 5.

- Junior College (Junior College 1 to 2 – Optional) OR Polytechnic (3 years – Optional)

There are also schools which have the [integrated program](#), such as [River Valley High School \(Singapore\)](#), which means they stay in the same school from Secondary 1 to Junior College 2, without having to take the "O" level examinations which most students take at the end of secondary school.

International schools are subject to overseas curriculums, such as the British, American, Canadian or Australian Boards.